

KERALA BECKONS VISITORS FOR STUNNINGLY UNIQUE EXPERIENCES

Kerala Tourism has been on an upswing since 2022, overcoming the devastation spawned by the Covid-19 pandemic. Trend-setting policy initiatives, new projects and a firm government-industry partnership have combined to impart a fresh dynamism to the state's tourism sector.

This uptrend has been especially true of the domestic footfall. The figures since 2022 unambiguously demonstrate that Kerala is the first and the best choice of tourists from all parts of the country. With international air traffic getting back to normal, foreign tourist arrivals too have started gaining momentum.

If the last two years have shown the resilience of Kerala Tourism, the current year is going to surpass all past records.

A firmly positioned global brand, Kerala Tourism received a clutch of prestigious honours recognizing its remarkable position in the post-pandemic world. India Today ranked Kerala as the Best Performing Big State in tourism in 2022.

TIME magazine featured the state as one of the 50 Extraordinary Destinations on the planet. "If you arrive in Kerala from elsewhere in India, you will feel that you have landed in a different country—God's Own Country, as Keralites like to call", wrote The New York Times. Kerala's globally-appreciated Responsible Tourism initiative received an award at World Travel Market, London.

Kerala has always pursued a tourism strategy based on inclusiveness and sustainability. The state's recent tourism initiatives have been firmly founded on this ideal. Kerala is stunningly unique as an all-season experiential destination that promises a pleasant experience for all segments of visitors.

Apart from promoting the time-tested destinations like beaches, backwaters, houseboats and hill stations, Kerala recently made a strategic shift of rolling out the entire state as an extended tourist haven.

Now visitors to Kerala can make their choice from a variety of options. They can have varied experiences within the span of a few days – be it a houseboat ride on the placid backwaters of Alappuzha or Kumarakom, the salubrious ambience of the forest-fringed uplands in Idukki or Wayanad, the impeccable hospitality of local communities in unspoilt countryside – just to mention a few. This upfront initiative has also added a variety of activities to the wholesome mix, so that tourists will have no dull moment while in Kerala.

The new projects like Keravan Kerala, the caravan safari through the state, have elicited heartening response from both the domestic and international tourists, leapfrogging Kerala's foray into niche tourism products.

Heritage and cultural tourism also got a boost. Malayali's iconic Onam festival in August-September is being marketed globally as the best time